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**Subject Name- Organizational Behaviour
Subject Code- 40050**

FAT 2

**Title - Understanding and Enhancing Employee
Motivation in Contemporary Workplaces**

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Submitted to- Dr. Purna Pechetty, Assistant Professor, School of Business

1. Introduction:

Employees are the most valuable assets of any organization, and their performance determines the overall success of the business. In today's competitive environment, organizations strive to not only attract but also retain competent and committed employees. One of the most critical factors influencing employee behavior and productivity is motivation. Motivation acts as the inner drive that directs individuals to achieve personal and organizational goals. It is closely linked with factors such as job satisfaction, efficiency, and workplace engagement.

This report aims to explore the concept and importance of motivation in the workplace. It discusses the various types and theories of motivation, supported by primary data collected from working professionals. Through this analysis, the study seeks to understand how motivation impacts employee performance and what practical initiatives organizations can implement to create a more motivated and productive workforce.

1.1 Significance of Motivation

Motivation holds great significance in the field of organizational behavior as it directly influences how employees think, feel, and perform. A motivated workforce not only contributes to higher productivity but also enhances the overall quality of work and job satisfaction. When employees feel valued and recognized, they are more likely to take ownership of their responsibilities and align their efforts with the organization's objectives. Motivation helps transform potential into performance by bridging the gap between an employee's ability and their willingness to perform.

From an organizational perspective, motivation serves as a key driver of growth, innovation, and competitiveness. It reduces absenteeism, lowers turnover rates, and fosters creativity by encouraging employees to think beyond routine tasks. For instance, Google is widely known for its "20% time policy," which allows employees to spend part of their working hours on personal projects. This policy has led to the development of successful products like Gmail and Google News, proving how intrinsic motivation can spark innovation. Similarly, Infosys focuses on continuous learning through its Global Education Center in Mysuru, motivating employees to develop new skills and remain future-ready.

Companies like Tata Group and Mahindra & Mahindra emphasize employee welfare and ethical leadership, which create a strong sense of belonging and loyalty among employees. Their focus on community welfare and inclusive practices boosts not just extrinsic but also intrinsic motivation. In the hospitality sector, Marriott International follows the philosophy "Take care of associates and they'll take care of customers," which has resulted in consistently high employee engagement and customer satisfaction rates.

Motivation also plays a critical role in smaller organizations and startups, where resources are limited but passion and purpose drive performance. For example, many Indian startups like Zomato and Swiggy motivate employees through recognition programs, open communication, and flexible working culture, which enhance trust and morale even under high-pressure conditions.

For managers, understanding motivation is essential to designing effective reward systems and performance strategies. By identifying what drives their employees—whether financial incentives, recognition, growth opportunities, or autonomy—managers can create conditions that sustain long-term engagement.

In essence, motivation is the foundation of human performance in organizations. It is not limited to external rewards but extends to internal satisfaction derived from meaningful work and personal growth. A motivated employee contributes not only to organizational success but also to creating a workplace that is dynamic, innovative, and fulfilling for everyone involved.

1.2 Concept of Motivation:

Motivation refers to the inner drive or force that stimulates a person to act toward achieving a goal. It is what energizes, directs, and sustains human behavior.

In other words, motivation explains why people do what they do — whether it's working hard, studying, helping others, or improving themselves.

According to **Stephen P. Robbins**, motivation is “the process that accounts for an individual's intensity, direction, and persistence of effort toward attaining a goal.”

In simpler terms, motivation explains why people behave in certain ways and how intensely they strive to achieve their goals.

Motivation can arise from internal (intrinsic) factors—such as personal growth, achievement, or interest in the task—or external (extrinsic) factors—such as rewards, recognition, or fear of punishment. Understanding motivation is crucial for leaders, educators, and managers because it directly impacts employee engagement, efficiency, and organizational success.

Key Points:

- Motivation links to needs, desires, and goals.
- It influences both effort (how hard someone works) and persistence (how long they keep trying).
- In organizations, motivation is crucial because it affects performance, productivity, and job satisfaction.

2. Theoretical Framework:

2.1 Types of Motivation:

Motivation can be classified in several ways, but the two main types are:

Intrinsic Motivation (Internal):

- Comes from within the individual.
- Driven by personal satisfaction, curiosity, or passion for the task itself.
- The person works because they enjoy it, not because of an external reward.

Key Features:

- Originates from internal desires.
- Leads to higher creativity and long-term engagement.
- Promotes self-fulfillment and personal growth

Examples:

Learning a new skill because you love learning.

Volunteering because it makes you feel good.

Completing a project because it feels meaningful.

Extrinsic Motivation (External):

- Comes from outside factors such as rewards, recognition, money, or avoiding punishment.
- The motivation is linked to the outcome, not necessarily the task itself.

Key Features:

- Based on tangible or social rewards (money, praise, grades).
- Can be effective in the short term.
- Often needs reinforcement to sustain behavior

Examples:

Working for a salary or bonus.

Studying to get good grades.

Following rules to avoid penalties.

Other Classifications (based on psychology):

1. Positive Motivation – Positive motivation is based on the promise of rewards. Individuals are encouraged to perform better when they anticipate positive outcomes such as appreciation, bonuses, or career advancement.

Example: Employees striving for “Employee of the Month” recognition.

Key Features:

- Encourages enthusiasm and initiative.
- Creates a supportive and optimistic work culture.

2. Negative Motivation – Negative motivation involves the fear of punishment or adverse consequences. It encourages people to act to avoid unpleasant outcomes such as demotion, reprimand, or failure.

Example: A student studying hard to avoid failing an exam.

Key Features:

- Can be effective for immediate results.
- Overuse may cause stress, resentment, or low morale.

3. Achievement Motivation – This type focuses on the drive to excel, achieve goals, and succeed. Individuals with strong achievement motivation set challenging goals and seek feedback on their performance.

Example: Entrepreneurs striving to build a successful startup.

Key Features:

- Strong desire for personal achievement.
- Emphasis on excellence and performance standards.

4. Power Motivation – Power motivation is the desire to influence, control, or lead others and to gain recognition.

Example: Managers or leaders who derive satisfaction from guiding and influencing their teams.

Key Features:

- Linked to leadership and authority.

- Can be used positively (to empower others) or negatively (to dominate).

5. Affiliation Motivation – Affiliation motivation refers to the drive to form social relationships, belong to groups, and be accepted by others.

Example: Employees motivated by teamwork and harmonious workplace relations.

Key Features:

- Focuses on relationships and cooperation.
- Encourages collaboration and group cohesion.

In Simple Terms:

- Motivation is the reason behind your actions.
- It can come from your heart (intrinsic) or from the world around you (extrinsic).
- Both are important — but intrinsic motivation often leads to long-term satisfaction and growth.

2.2 Theories:

1) Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory

What the theory says:

Herzberg explains motivation in two parts:

- **Hygiene Factors:** Salary, work policies, supervision, job security, work-life balance. These don't motivate when present, but when they are missing, employees feel dissatisfied.
- **Motivator Factors:** Recognition, learning, responsibility, meaningful work, growth. These actually motivate employees when present.

How this relates to the responses:

From the survey, many employees felt demotivated because of low compensation, poor leadership communication, lack of recognition, and no growth opportunities. These are all hygiene factors. Since these factors were weak, dissatisfaction increased.

On the other hand, employees reported feeling motivated when they received career growth opportunities, skill development, meaningful work, and positive work culture. These are motivator factors that encourage satisfaction and engagement.

So, the responses show a clear reflection of Herzberg's idea that improving salary alone is not enough; organisations must also provide recognition, development, and meaningful roles to truly motivate employees.

2) Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs

What the theory says:

Maslow states that human needs rise in levels:

1. Basic Needs (Salary, job security)
2. Safety Needs (Stable work environment)
3. Social Needs (Team belonging)
4. Esteem Needs (Recognition, appreciation)
5. Self-Actualization (Growth, learning, fulfilling work)

As one level is satisfied, individuals move to the next.

How this relates to the responses:

The employees in this survey are mostly not struggling with basic salary or survival, but they are strongly seeking belonging, recognition and growth, which fall under the Social, Esteem, and Self-Actualization needs.

Many responses highlight:

- Desire for team culture and supportive leadership → **Social Need**
- Need for recognition and appreciation → **Esteem Need**
- Need for career development and challenging work → **Self-Actualization Need**

This shows that employees are currently positioned in the higher levels of Maslow's hierarchy, meaning the organisation should focus more on recognition, growth opportunities, and skill development rather than just salary-based incentives.

3. Methodology

- **Type of Research:**

The study uses **descriptive research**, which means it focuses on understanding and describing the motivation levels and workplace factors influencing employees, based on their experiences and perceptions.

- **Nature of Data:**

The data collected is **primary data**, because it was gathered **directly from the employees** using a survey, instead of taking it from books or previous reports.

- **Data Collection Method:**

The data was obtained through a **structured questionnaire (Google Form)**. Respondents provided their answers to questions related to motivation, demotivating factors, leadership support, and workplace environment.

- **Sample Size:**

The survey responses were collected from **around 25 working professionals** belonging to different industries such as IT, Banking, Finance, Digital Marketing, Manufacturing, etc.

- **Sampling Technique:**

The sampling used was **Convenience Sampling**. This means participants who were easily reachable and willing to respond were included in the study. The sample was not selected randomly, but based on accessibility.

- **Participant Profile:**

Most participants were **21–30 years old**, working in **hybrid, on-site or remote work models**, which helped provide a diverse understanding of motivation across different work setups.

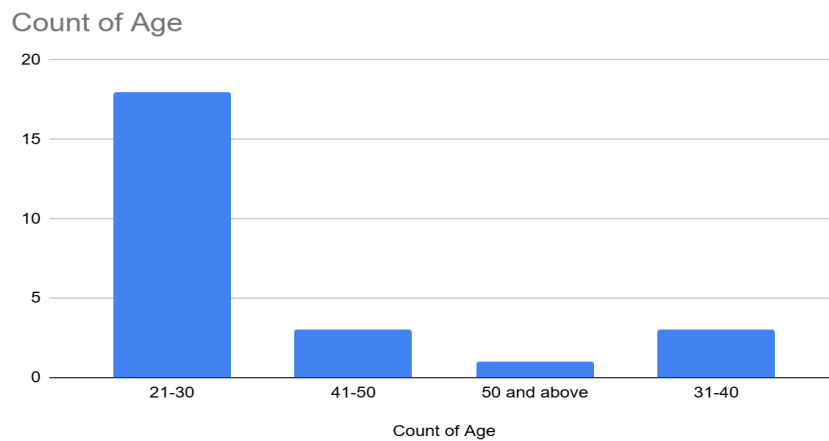
- **Tools Used for Analysis:**

The responses were analyzed using **simple frequency and percentage comparison** to interpret common motivational trends, demotivating factors, and overall employee sentiment.

4. Data Analysis and Interpretation:

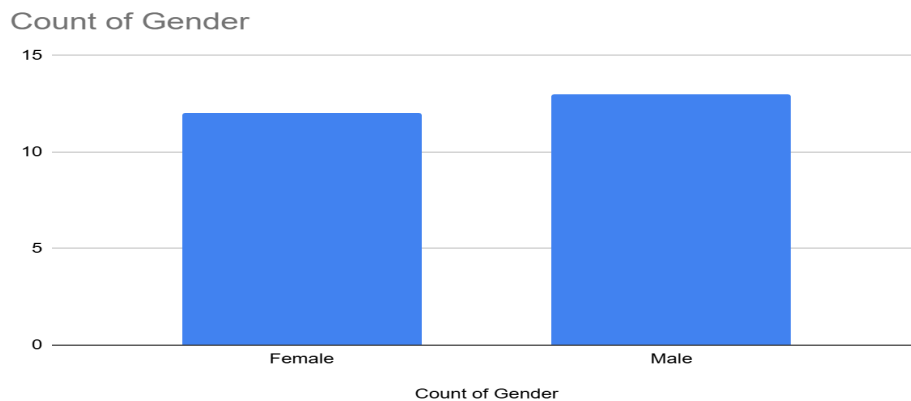
Demographic Information:

Age:



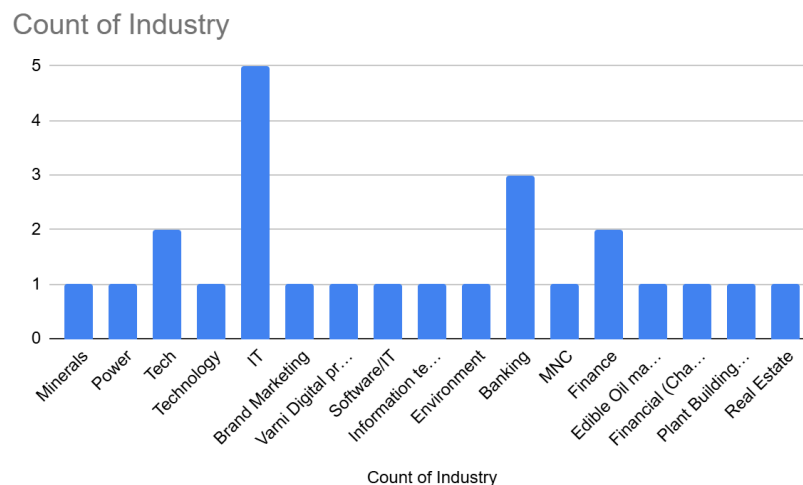
Most respondents (around 85%) belong to the 21–30 age group, indicating that the survey primarily represents a young workforce in their early career stages. A smaller proportion falls in the 31–40 and 41–50 brackets, while only a few are above 50. This shows that insights from this survey mainly reflect the motivational factors of millennials and Gen Z professionals.

Gender:



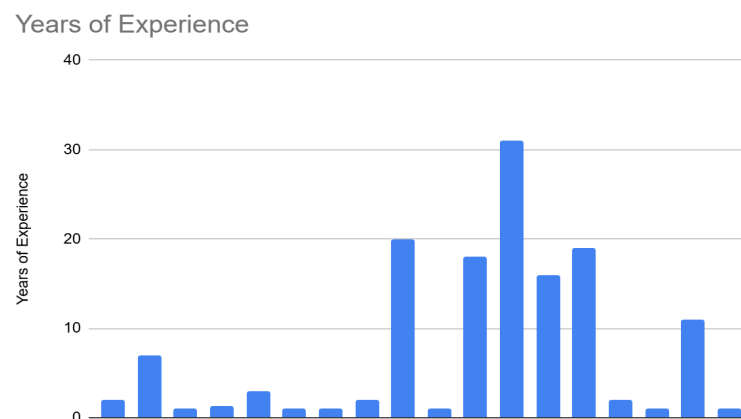
The sample includes both male and female participants, with a slight majority of males (about 60%). The female representation (around 40%) reflects a fairly balanced gender ratio, offering a reasonable basis for comparing perceptions between genders. The responses indicate no major gender-specific trend, suggesting that motivation and engagement factors are largely consistent across both groups.

Type of Industry:



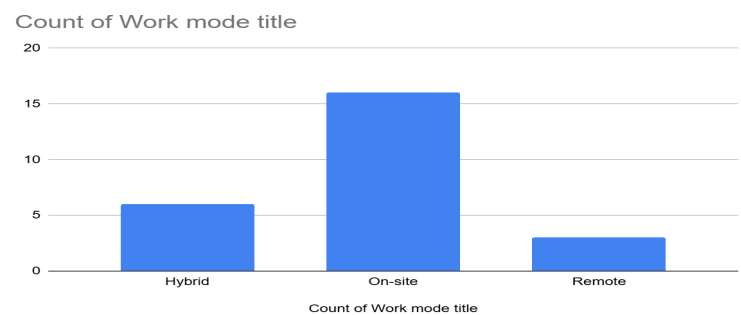
Participants came from diverse sectors including IT, Technology, Banking, Finance, Marketing, and Manufacturing. The IT and Technology sectors formed the largest share (around 45%), followed by Finance and Banking (20%), and others like Marketing, Minerals, and Real Estate making up the rest. This diversity strengthens the study's reliability while emphasizing that learning opportunities and work culture are key motivators across all industries.

Years of Experience:



A significant portion of respondents (70%) have 1–5 years of experience, while a smaller set has over 10 years of professional exposure. This suggests that the data mostly represents early-career employees who are still developing professional direction and skill sets. The insights thus highlight what motivates newer employees the most and where organizational structures might better support growth.

Work Mode:



The responses show a mix of on-site (about 50%), hybrid (35%), and remote (15%) employees. This blend suggests that the organization supports flexible work models. Interestingly, hybrid and remote workers reported comparable motivation levels to on-site employees, though some expressed challenges like maintaining routine and communication gaps, indicating a need for enhanced virtual engagement practices.

Survey Questions:

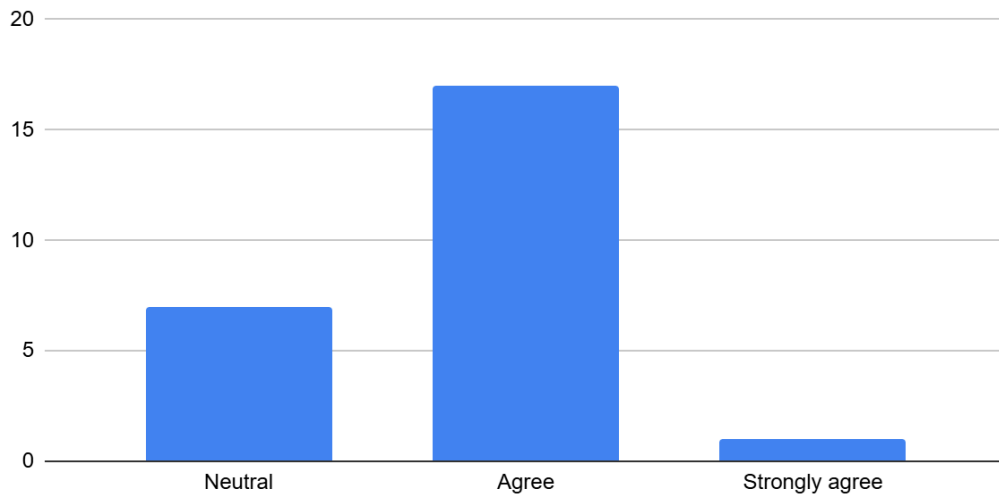
- 1. I feel motivated to give my best at work everyday.



A majority of employees (around 85%) either agreed or remained neutral, showing a generally positive attitude toward their work. However, the limited number of strongly agree responses suggests motivation could be further strengthened through targeted engagement and recognition efforts.

2. I find my work meaningful and fulfilling.

Count of I find my work meaningful and fulfilling.

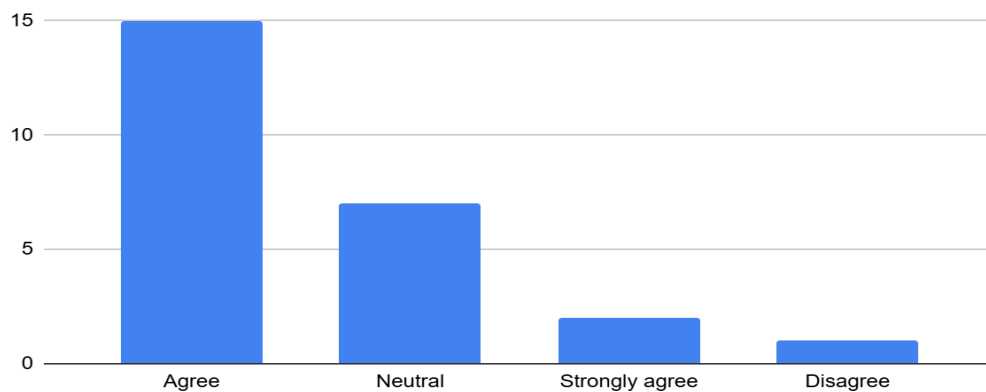


Count of I find my work meaningful and fulfilling.

About 52% of respondents agreed that their work feels meaningful, indicating a healthy level of purpose. The remaining neutral responses imply that while work provides stability, employees may not always find it deeply fulfilling.

3. I look forward to coming to work (virtually or physically).

Count of I look forward to coming to work (virtually or physically).

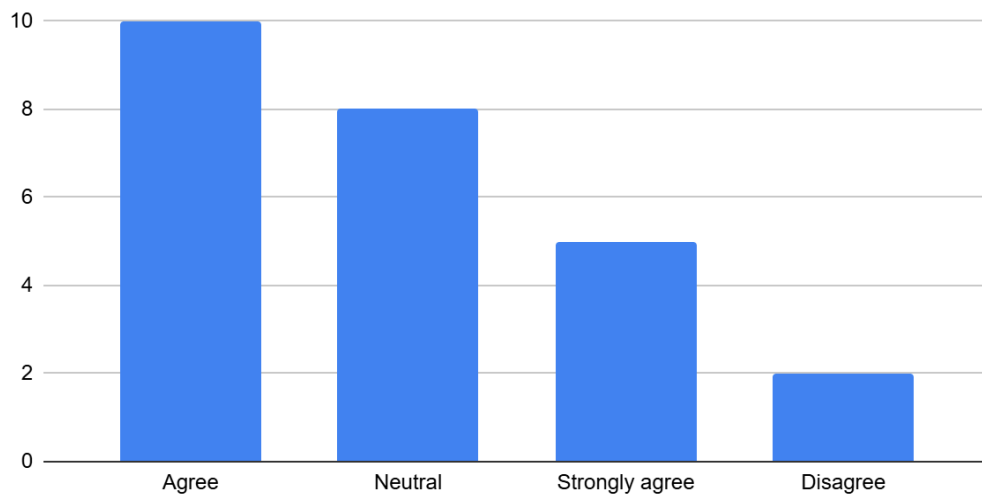


Count of I look forward to coming to work (virtually or physically).

Nearly 46% of participants look forward to work, but the high neutral response rate points to moderate enthusiasm. This suggests that employees enjoy their environment but may desire more inspiration or variety in daily tasks.

4. I feel my efforts are appreciated by the organisation.

Count of I feel my efforts are appreciated by the organisation.

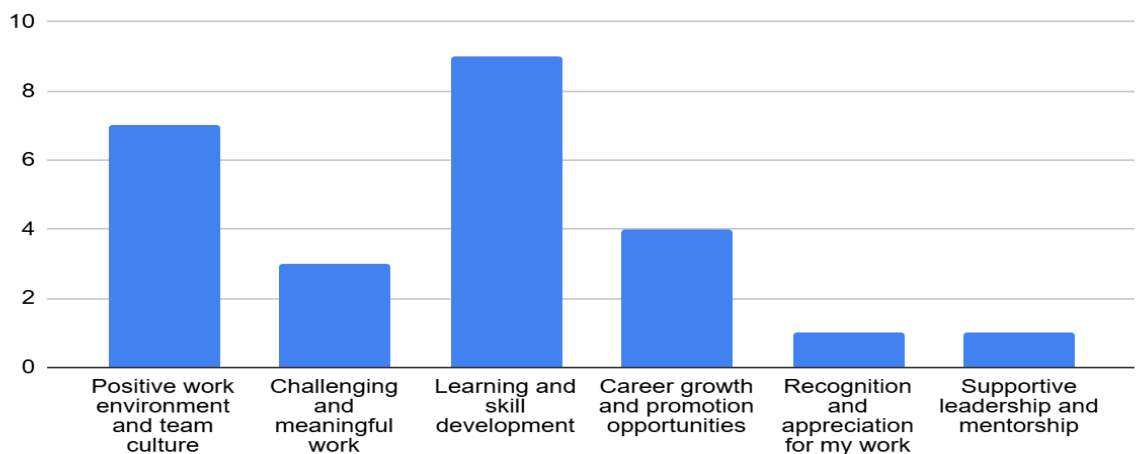


Count of I feel my efforts are appreciated by the organisation.

Almost half of the respondents feel appreciated for their work. The rest expressed neutrality, indicating that appreciation exists but is not consistently experienced by everyone.

5. What currently motivates you the most in your job?

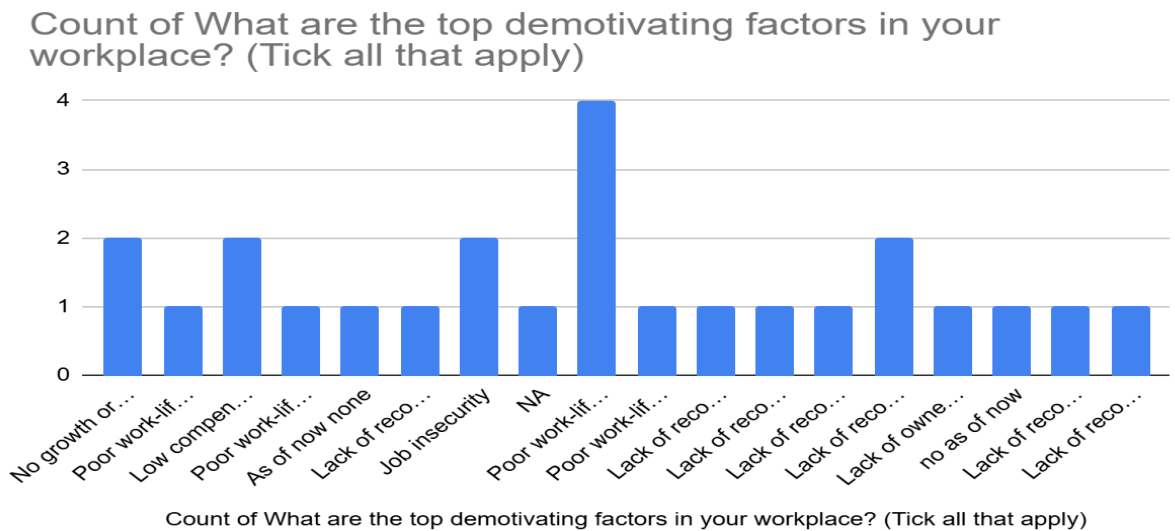
Count of What currently motivates you the most in your job?



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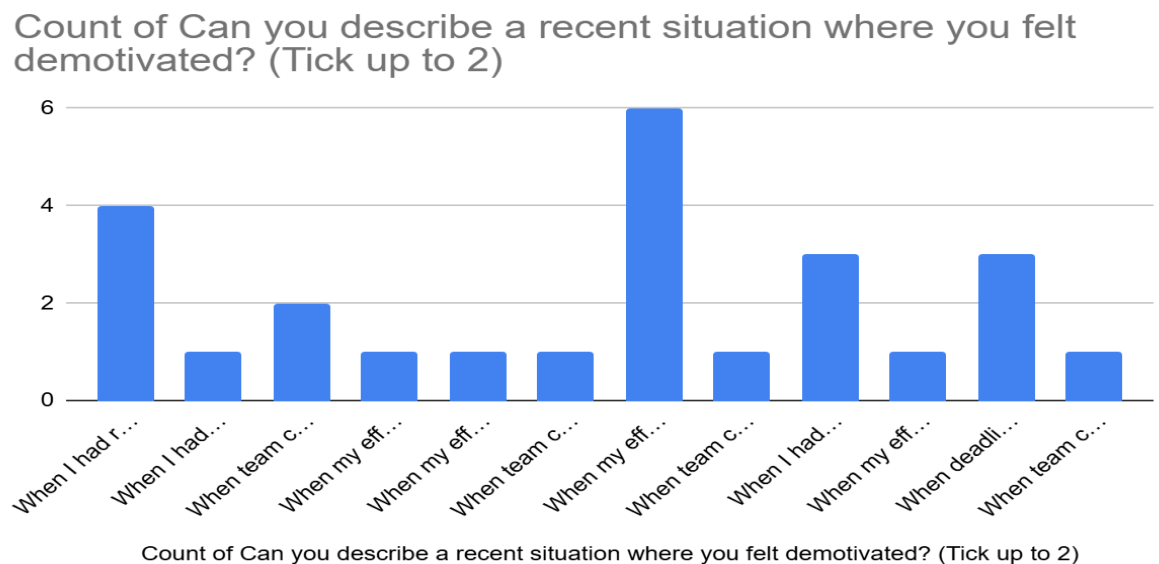
The most common motivators were learning and skill development (35%), followed by career growth (25%) and positive team culture (20%). These results underline that intrinsic motivators like development and growth play a stronger role than purely monetary ones.

6. What are the top demotivating factors in your workplace?



Key demotivators included poor work-life balance (22%), low compensation (20%), and lack of growth opportunities (18%). The pattern reflects that organizational structure and management practices influence motivation more than workload alone.

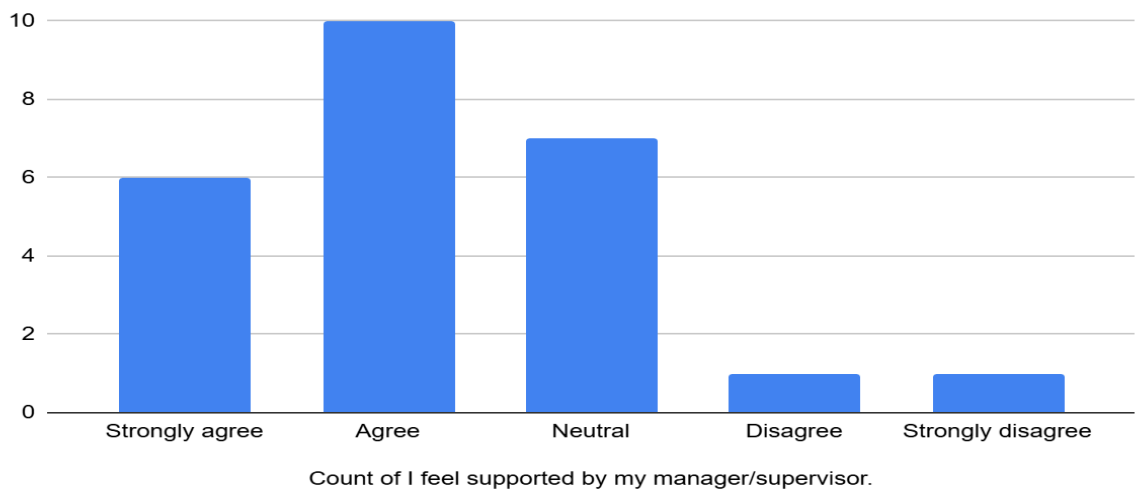
7. Can you describe a recent situation where you felt demotivated?



The main causes of demotivation were unclear goals (26%), repetitive tasks (23%), and lack of recognition (21%). This highlights that unclear expectations and lack of acknowledgment reduce engagement levels.

8. I feel supported by my manager/ supervisor ?

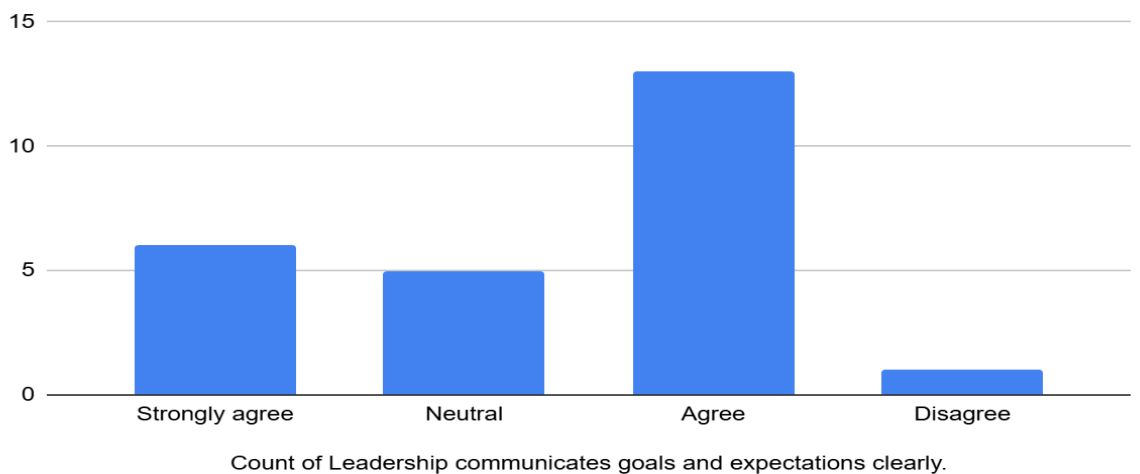
Count of I feel supported by my manager/supervisor.



About 56% of employees agreed, showing that most feel adequately guided by their managers. However, nearly one-third remained neutral, suggesting some teams need more proactive managerial involvement.

9. Leadership communicates goals and expectations clearly.

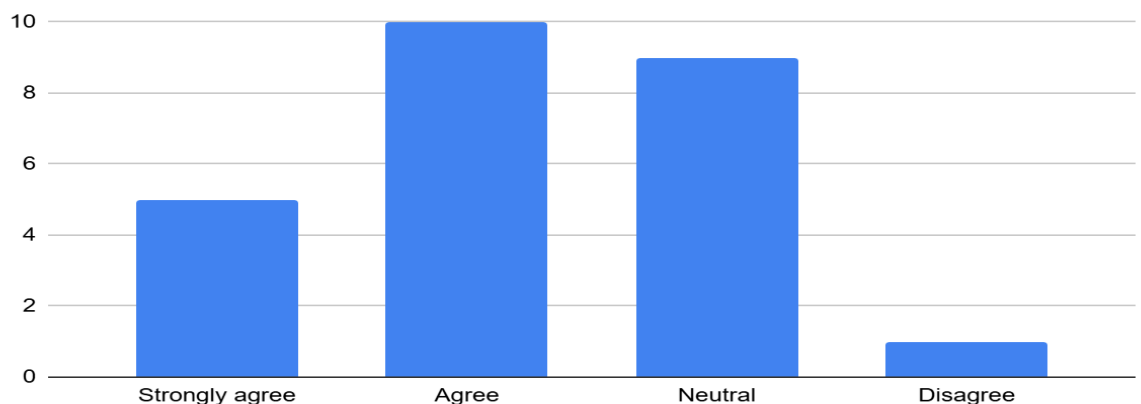
Count of Leadership communicates goals and expectations clearly.



More than half of the respondents rated this positively, showing good leadership transparency. Yet, around one-fifth disagreed, reflecting occasional gaps in communication flow.

10. I believe my leaders care about my growth and well-being.

Count of I believe my leaders care about my growth and well-being.

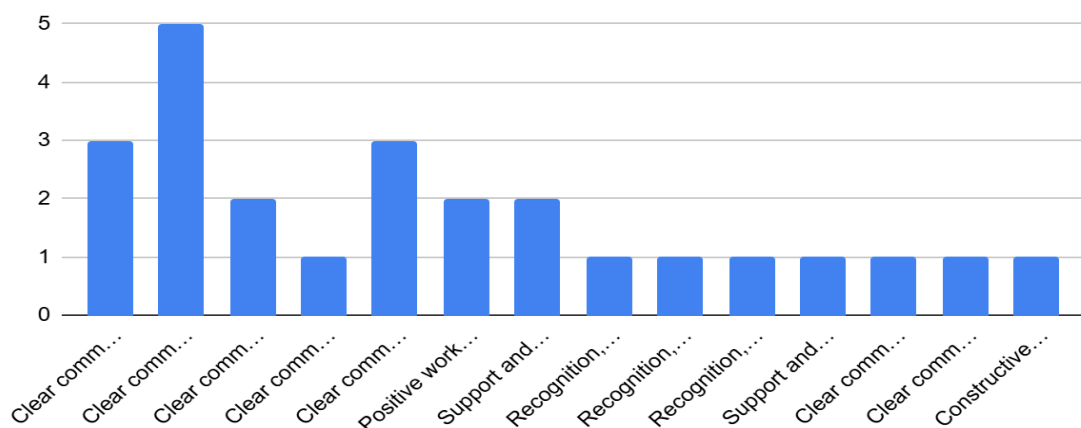


Count of I believe my leaders care about my growth and well-being.

Nearly 48% agreed, while others were neutral. This indicates employees recognize leadership efforts but still expect more personalized engagement and growth-oriented discussions.

11. What do you expect from your leadership to stay motivated?

Count of What do you expect from your leadership to stay motivated? (Tick up to 3)



Count of What do you expect from your leadership to stay motivated? (Tick up to 3)

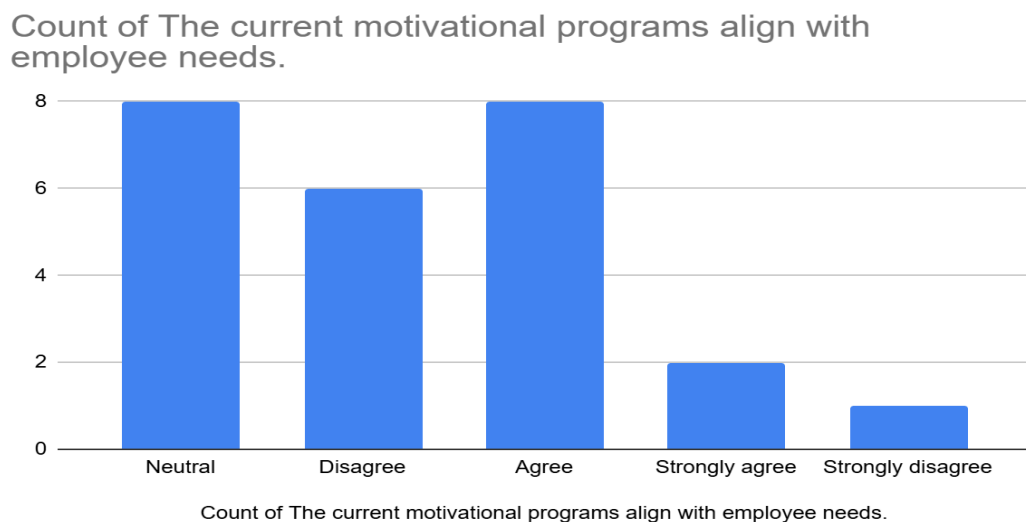
The top expectations include clear communication (70%), support and guidance (65%), and recognition (60%). These responses highlight the importance of consistent feedback, clarity, and appreciation from leadership.

12. My organisation's rewards and recognition system is effective.



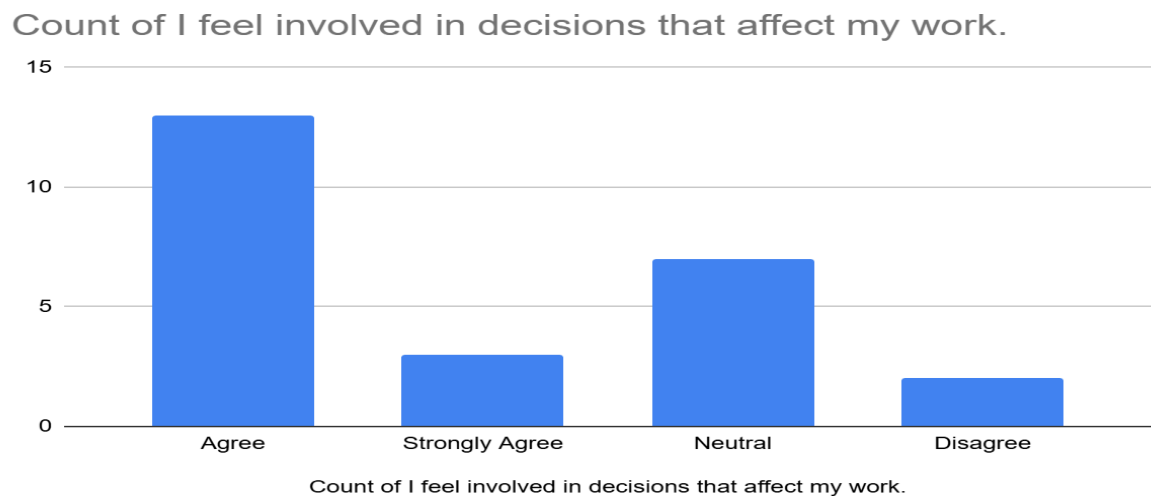
Around 44% agreed, while others were neutral or disagreed. The feedback implies that the recognition framework is present but lacks uniform effectiveness or visibility.

13. The current motivational programs align with employee needs.



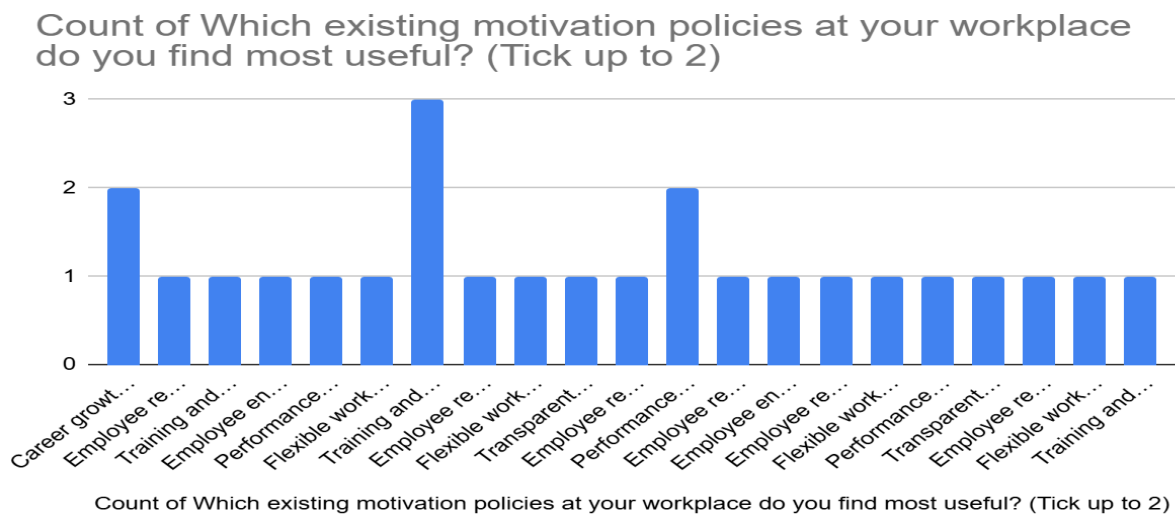
Only about 37% of participants agreed, while 40% were neutral. This signals a need to redesign motivation programs to better reflect employee expectations and changing work trends.

14. I feel involved in decisions that affect my work.



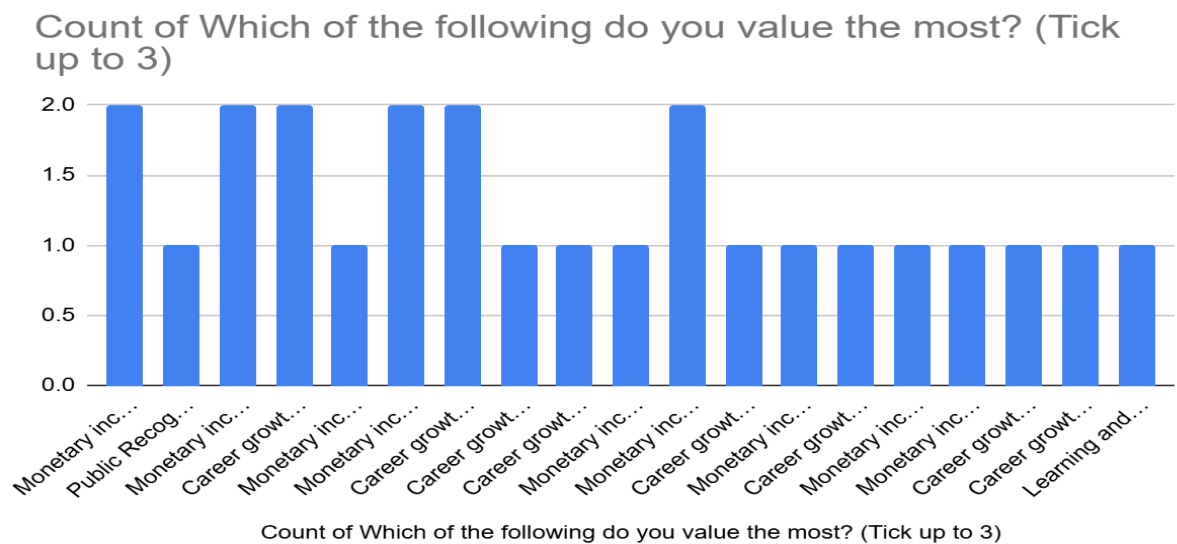
Over half of the employees feel included in decisions, showing participative management practices. However, the neutral responses suggest some still feel excluded from key discussions.

15. Which existing motivation policies at your workplace do you find most useful.



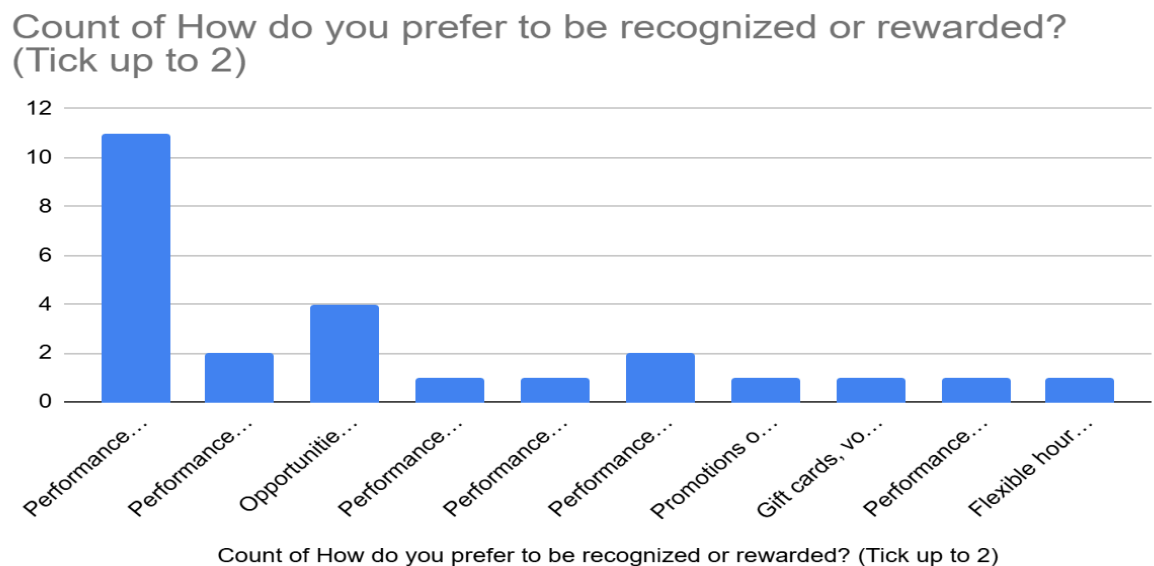
Employees found career growth and promotion opportunities (29%) and recognition programs (25%) most effective. These two areas appear to be the most impactful retention drivers.

16. Which of the following do you value the most?



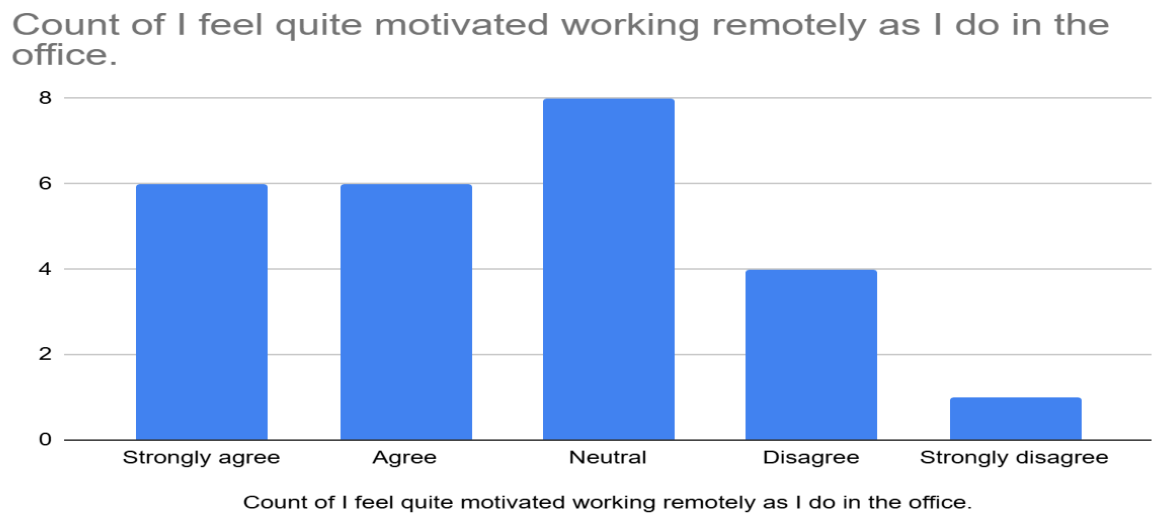
Top values include career growth (32%), learning opportunities (28%), and monetary rewards (25%). Professional development clearly outweighs short-term incentives in motivating employees.

17. How do you prefer to be recognized or rewarded?



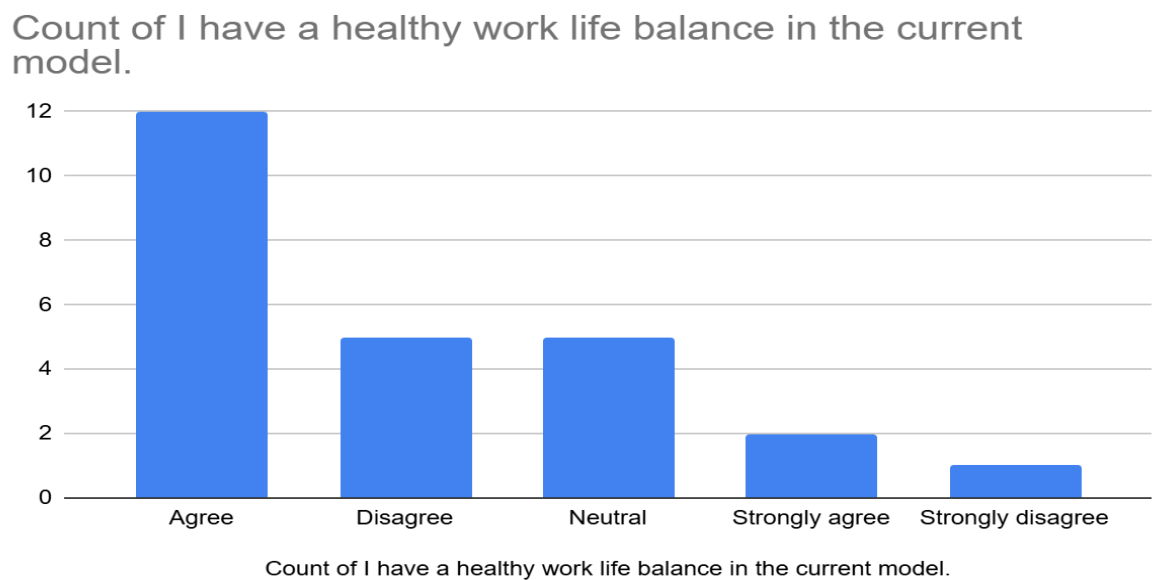
Most employees prefer performance-based bonuses (42%) and promotion opportunities (33%) over verbal recognition. This highlights that tangible and career-linked rewards have stronger motivational impact.

18. I feel quite motivated working remotely as I do in the office.



About 58% of employees remain motivated even when working remotely, showing adaptability to hybrid setups. This reflects a strong sense of autonomy and self-motivation among respondents.

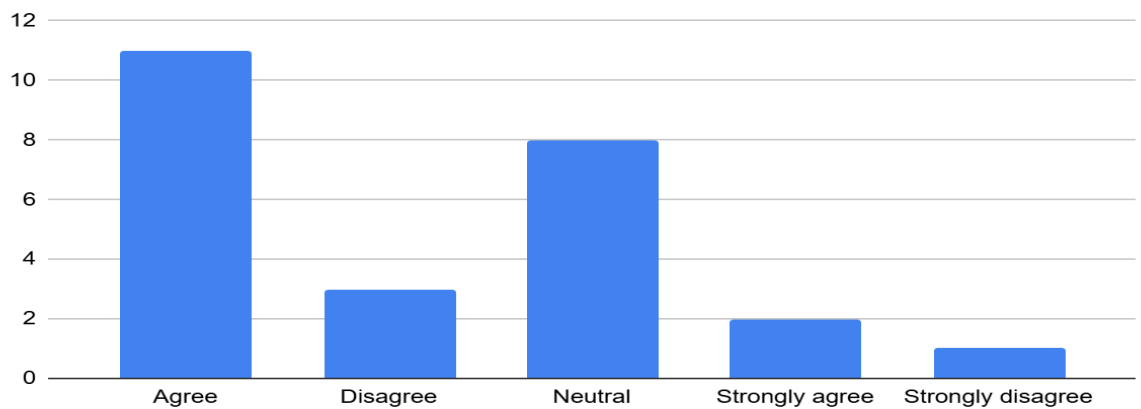
19. I have a healthy work life balance in the current model.



Roughly 49% agree that they maintain balance, while 31% were neutral and 20% disagreed. This suggests growing awareness but still some struggle, especially in hybrid or high-pressure roles.

20. My organization ensures I stay connected and engaged while working remotely.

Count of My organization ensures I stay connected and engaged while working remotely.

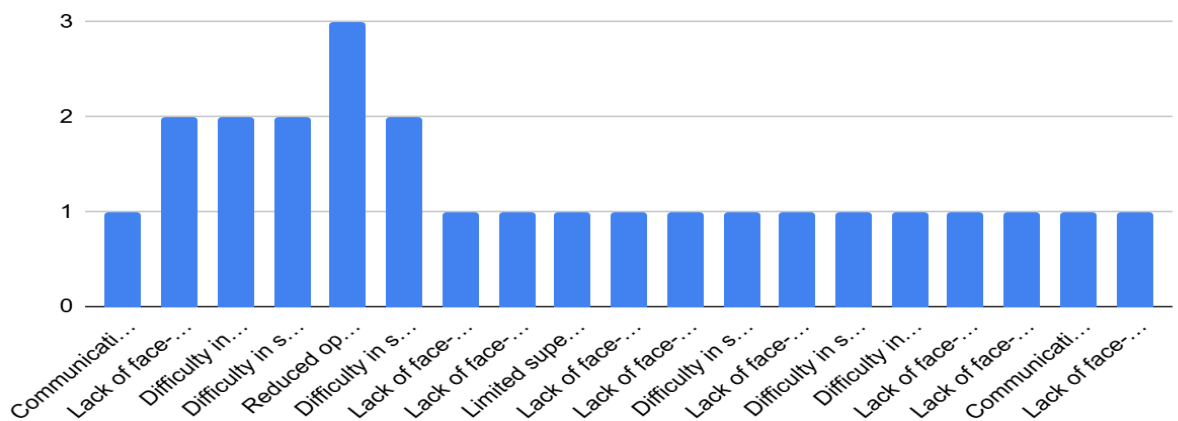


Count of My organization ensures I stay connected and engaged while working remotely.

Almost half of the employees feel connected, while the rest expressed uncertainty. This highlights the need for more structured virtual engagement and team bonding activities.

21. What challenges do you face in staying motivated while working from home/ hybrid?

Count of What challenges do you face in staying motivated while working from home/ hybrid? (Tick up to 2)

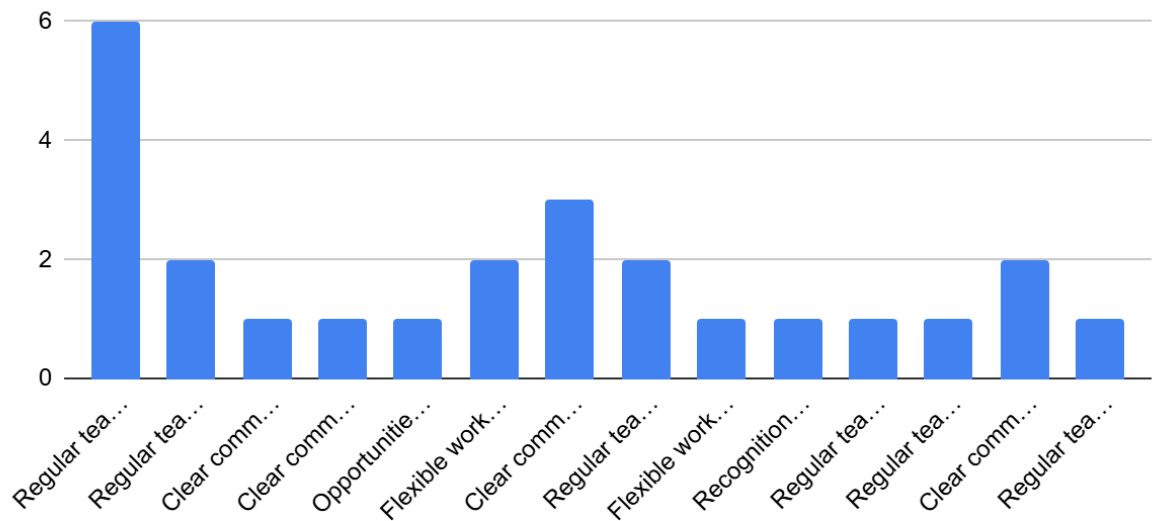


Count of What challenges do you face in staying motivated while working from home/ hybrid? (Tick...

Common challenges include communication gaps (28%) and difficulty maintaining routine (24%). These issues point to the importance of digital collaboration tools and regular check-ins.

22. What suggestions do you have for improving motivation in the hybrid/remote setup?

Count of What suggestions do you have for improving motivation in the hybrid/remote setup? (Tick up to 2)



Count of What suggestions do you have for improving motivation in the hybrid/remote setup? (Tick...

Employees recommended regular team meetings (32%), clear goal communication (28%), and flexible schedules (22%) as the best ways to enhance motivation in remote models.

5. Findings:

- **Moderate Motivation Levels:**
From the data we collected, found that most employees are motivated, few show signs of disengagement due to repetitive work or unclear direction.
- **Limited Growth Opportunities:**
Many respondents feel there are not enough training or development programs to enhance their skills or career prospects.
- **Lack Of Recognition:**
It is found that an employee's hard work often goes unnoticed, which reduces morale and motivation.
- **Communication Gaps:**
Some employees feel that leadership communication is irregular and expectations are not always clearly defined.
- **Work-Life Balance:**
Several employees, especially in hybrid or remote roles, struggle to maintain a healthy balance between personal and professional life.
- **Low Participation In Decision Making:**
Employees feel they are rarely included in decisions that affect their work, leading to lack of ownership.
- **Inconsistent Feedback:**
Regular performance feedback or appreciation, discussions are missing, causing confusion about improvement areas.
- **Team Engagement Decline:**
Team interactions and bonding have decreased, especially after the shift to hybrid or remote work setups.

5.1 Suggestions:

- **Enhance Learning and Growth Programs:**
Introduce continuous learning workshops, job-rotations, and mentorship to promote personal and professional development.
- **Implement a Recognition System:**
Start appreciating employees by giving them 'Employee of the Month' awards, appreciation posts, and team-based reward initiatives.
- **Strengthen Leadership Communication:**
Encourage transparent communication through regular team meetings and open-door discussions with managers.
- **Promote Work-Life Balance:**
Offer flexible working hours, wellness days, and stress-relief sessions to improve employee satisfaction.
- **Encourage Employee Involvement:**
Involve employees in goal-setting, problem-solving, and decision-making to build ownership and motivation.
- **Provide Continuous Feedback:**
Conduct monthly performance discussions, appreciation emails, and constructive feedback sessions to keep employees aligned.
- **Build Strong Team Culture:**
Organize regular team-building activities, offsite events, or virtual bonding sessions to strengthen team bondings.
- **Use Data to Improve Engagement:**
Conduct quarterly employee engagement surveys and use insights to design focused motivation strategies.

6. Motivation Initiatives:

- **Structured learning and development program:**
This would ensure continuous growth of the employee. This can be done through monthly workshops - technical & soft skills , certification sponsorship and mentorship - buddy system. These initiatives will help employees to upskill, shape their career path, and develop themselves for future opportunities. This also portrays that the company values employee success and long term learning.
- **Career Progression and Promotion Framework:**
Providing a clear career progression and promotion framework helps employees to work upon the skills that would facilitate this growth. This would also further reduce ambiguity, enhance motivation and refrain employees from having negative thoughts about their career progression in the organization.
- **Rewards and Recognition:**
A monthly R and R program acknowledges employees' efforts. Celebration can be done either formally or informally which would create a positive work environment, boost morale and drive organizational success.
- **Leadership Communication:**
Regular meeting with top level leaders would help in aligning the organizational goals with the personal goals of the employee. This would create a sense of ownership as well among the employees. Clarity and trust building will also be taken care of through this.
- **Wellness and Work Life Balance:**
Wellness and Work life balance initiatives would create a healthy, happy and sustainable work environment. This can be done through providing flexible working hours, organising mental well being workshops and creating a safe space where employees could easily share their issues.
- **Team Building:**
Team Building would play a crucial role in employee engagement and well being. Fun Fridays can be organized for the employees so that they can build connections with each other and also get to spend some time apart from their work schedule. Also, trips can be organized on yearly basis for reinvigoration.

- Employee Forum:

The organization can have an employee forum where the employees can raise their concerns and also give their suggestions regarding an improvement that can be made in the organization. This will also create a feeling among the employees that they are being valued at the organization.

7. Conclusion:

Employee motivation is one of the key factors that drives organizational success. It influences productivity, commitment and the culture. Through the survey we could analyze that most of the employees show moderate motivation. They have concerns related to communication, growth opportunities, recognition and work-life balance. These factors are often overlooked in organizations. In the long run this can create dissatisfaction among employees that would further hamper their productivity.

The initiatives that are proposed in the report above can serve as a roadmap for enhancing employee engagement and satisfaction. By providing learning opportunities and a clear progression path will help employees gain a sense of direction and purpose. Rewards and recognition systems would foster a positive behavior. Other than this, clear and transparent communication between the management and employees would help in aligning the goals.

Additionally, having a proper work life balance as well as mental wellbeing among employees will contribute towards higher productivity and healthier surroundings. Activities like team building and collaboration will develop a sense of inclusivity and create a constructive organizational structure. These approaches would help build a people centric organization where employees would feel valued.

Eventually, motivation cannot be achieved through any single initiative- it is necessary to put continuous efforts that would ensure growth, recognition and well-being. When employees feel a sense of belongingness and inclusivity they tend to put in more effort. This sustainable culture will help the organization to position itself in the long run.

Annexure:

1	Name	Email Address	Job role/title
2	Foram Panwala	foramnidhi@gmail.com	Assistant manager
3	Yash Shah	syash0220@gmail.com	Project planning monito
4	Devaksh Bhagat	devakshbhagat8@gmail.com	Data scientist
5	Vansh Mathur	vanshmathur6568@gmail.com	Associate software engi
6	Bhargav Kargatiya	bhargavkargatiya2003@gmail.com	Software Developer Eng
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